

Observing Celestial Coordinate Systems using Stellarium?

Astronomy Activity

TEACHER NOTES

Warning: Upon opening the Stellarium Web Online site, you (the students) will be asked if you will allow your location to be shared. There may be a school policy that has a say about such things.

Level: Introductory at Middle School or High School

Objective: A fun, interactive activity to observe the Celestial Sphere with an online planetarium program, specifically, Stellarium

Pre-Knowledge of Students:

- 1) Very useful if this activity follows the DSPIRA Activity: Understanding Celestial Coordinate Systems
- 2) The activity can be a stand alone

Key Terms: Celestial Sphere, Equatorial, Right Ascension, Declination, Local Sky, Horizon, Zenith, Meridian, Azimuth, Altitude

Related Videos for Teacher:

[DSPIRA Stellarium Tutorial](#)

Teacher Preparation:

- Watch the video tutorial links above, and spend about a ½ hour using the site to get comfortable with the Stellarium environment.

Activity Notes:

- Could easily be done in or out of class..